

KOK Kitchens

Stripe Go-Live Guide

Switching card payments from test mode to live

Status: Card payments are already built and fully tested in **test mode** (payment → order → confirmation emails all verified). Going live is configuration only — **no code changes**. It is just swapping test keys for live keys and pointing a live webhook at the site.

Before you start

- Your Stripe account must be **fully activated** (business verification complete) — live charges are blocked until then.
- Do everything below with the Stripe Dashboard switched to **Live mode** (toggle, top-right). Live and test are completely separate — different keys, different webhook, different data.

Step 1 — Get your live secret key

1. Stripe Dashboard → switch to **Live mode**.
2. Developers → API keys → copy the **Secret key** (`sk_live_...`).

The publishable key is not needed — the site uses Stripe-hosted Checkout.

Step 2 — Add the live webhook

1. Still in **Live mode**: Developers → Webhooks → **Add destination** (a.k.a. Add endpoint).
2. Event: `checkout.session.completed`
3. Destination type: **Webhook endpoint**
4. Endpoint URL:
`https://kokkitchens.com/api/stripe/webhook`
(or `https://kok-kitchens.vercel.app/api/stripe/webhook` until the custom domain is connected)
5. Create it, then copy the **Signing secret** (`whsec_...`).

Important: the live signing secret is **different** from the test one. Use the secret from the **live-mode** webhook, or payments will succeed but orders will never be marked paid.

Step 3 — Update Vercel (Production)

Project → Settings → Environment Variables → set these to the live values:

Variable	Value
<code>STRIPE_SECRET_KEY</code>	<code>sk_live_...</code> (from Step 1)
<code>STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET</code>	<code>whsec_...</code> (from Step 2 — the live one)

Step 4 — Redeploy

Environment changes only take effect on a fresh deployment. Redeploy production (`vercel --prod` , or trigger a deploy from the dashboard).

Step 5 — One real-card smoke test

Test mode can't verify the live keys, live webhook, or payout path — so do exactly one real transaction:

1. Place a real order on the live site with a **real card** (use a small amount).
2. Confirm: payment succeeds, you reach the confirmation page, and the owner + customer emails arrive.
3. **Refund it** from the Stripe Dashboard (Payments → the payment → Refund).

Note: the Stripe processing fee may not be returned on a refund, so a live test costs a few pence. That's expected.

After launch

- Keep using **test** keys for any future development — test on preview deployments, never against the live site.
- All orders and payments are visible in the Stripe Dashboard. Funds settle to the connected bank account, typically within 2–3 business days.
- Stripe fees: roughly **1.5% + 20p** per UK card, deducted automatically. No monthly fee.

Questions? Reach out to Samuel on WhatsApp or email at samlawal@hotmail.com.